

Petition 5 — Simplify Fertilizer (Urea) Procurement for Genuine Farmers while Preventing Diversion

To: Shri M. Liju Hon'ble Minister for Co-operation, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri T. Siddique, Hon'ble Minister for Agriculture 2. Shri Anoop Jacob, Hon'ble Minister for Food, Civil Supplies & Consumer Affairs

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to simplify the procurement of urea and other subsidised fertilizers for genuine farmers — especially the elderly and tenant cultivators — while strengthening safeguards against diversion to the wrong persons.

1. Respected Sir,

Primary Agricultural Co-operative Societies (PACS) and co-operative outlets are the main channel through which our farmers buy fertilizer. The present procedure, though well-intentioned, has become **burdensome for genuine farmers** while still leaving gaps that allow diversion. We pray for a simpler, safer system.

2. The factual position

- 1. The current procedure.** Under the Union Government's **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) for fertilizers** (in force since 2017–18), all subsidised fertilizers — **urea, DAP, MOP, super-phosphate, etc.** — can be sold only through **Aadhaar-linked Point-of-Sale (PoS) machines with biometric (fingerprint) authentication**, with the buyer identified via Aadhaar / Kisan Credit Card / Voter ID and the sale logged in the integrated fertilizer management system (iFMS).
- 2. The difficulties on the ground.** In Palakkad, farmers report: - **Repeated demands for documents** — Aadhaar, and in practice **land-tax receipts / land records** — at every purchase; - **Fingerprint-authentication failures**, especially for **elderly farmers** and manual labourers; - **Exclusion of tenant / lease cultivators**, who till land they do not own and cannot readily produce land documents; - **Network / technical glitches** at PoS terminals, and problems with small-quantity purchases.
- 3. The genuine concern.** At the same time, safeguards are needed so that subsidised fertilizer is **not diverted** to non-agricultural / industrial use, bulk hoarders, or across the State border to the wrong persons.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister for Co-operation (through whom the PACS network functions), in coordination with Agriculture and Civil Supplies, to:

- 1. Introduce a one-time verified "Farmer ID / registration"** — issued through the PACS and linked once to the farmer's **Aadhaar, land / registered-lease record and Soil Health Card** — so that documents such as land-tax receipts **need not be produced at every purchase**; the PoS simply reads the pre-verified entitlement.
- 2. Permit biometric alternatives** (OTP / face authentication) and allow an **authorised family member or registered nominee** to purchase on behalf of elderly, ill or differently-abled farmers.

3. **Recognise registered tenant / lease cultivators** (through Padasekhara Samithis / lease registers / cultivation certificates from the Krishi Bhavan) so that landless-but-genuine farmers are not excluded.
4. **Do not insist on the land-tax receipt at each sale** once the one-time registration is complete.
5. **Strengthen anti-diversion safeguards** — enforce **crop-wise / area-wise entitlement ceilings** in the PoS / iFMS, flag abnormal or bulk purchases, and audit — so that fertilizer reaches only genuine cultivators and is blocked from wrong persons and cross-border diversion.
6. **Ensure adequate buffer stock and upgraded PoS connectivity** at PACS in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara during the peak sowing season.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Instances of document-related hardship (with dates / outlets).
- Annexure B: List of PACS outlets in the Chittur belt and their PoS status.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur